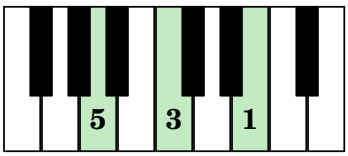
Unit 6

Accidentals

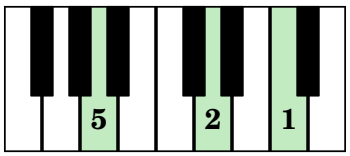
New: Sharps, flats and naturals inside the bar; the raised 7th in minor keys

A sharp, flat or natural written in the music, not in the key signature, is called an accidental. In minor keys you meet one all the time: the 7th note of the scale is raised by a half step so that it leads strongly home to the tonic. In A minor that note is G-sharp, although the key signature has no sharps at all.
This unit uses four minor keys: A minor and E minor from Volume 2, and two new ones, B minor (the relative minor of D major, two sharps) and G minor (the relative minor of B-flat major, two flats).

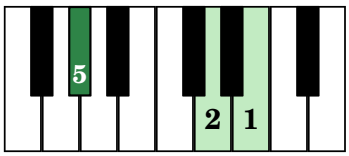
A minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Am

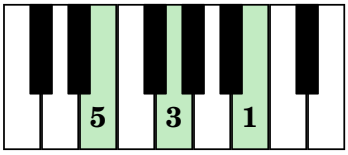


iv = Dm

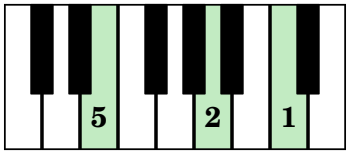


V7 = E7

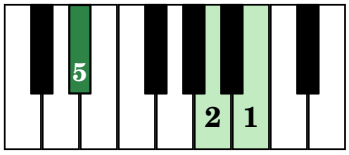
E minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Em

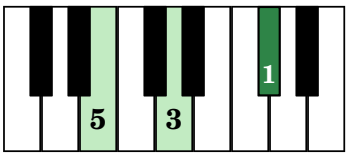


iv = Am

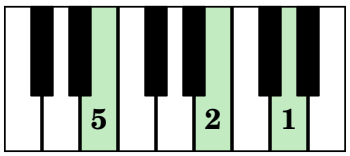


V7 = B7

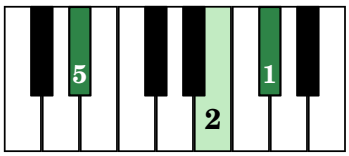
B minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Bm

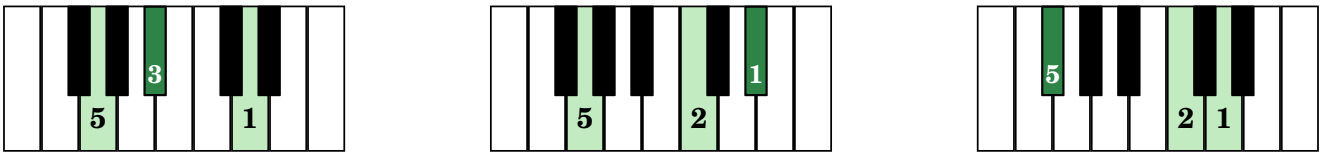


iv = Em



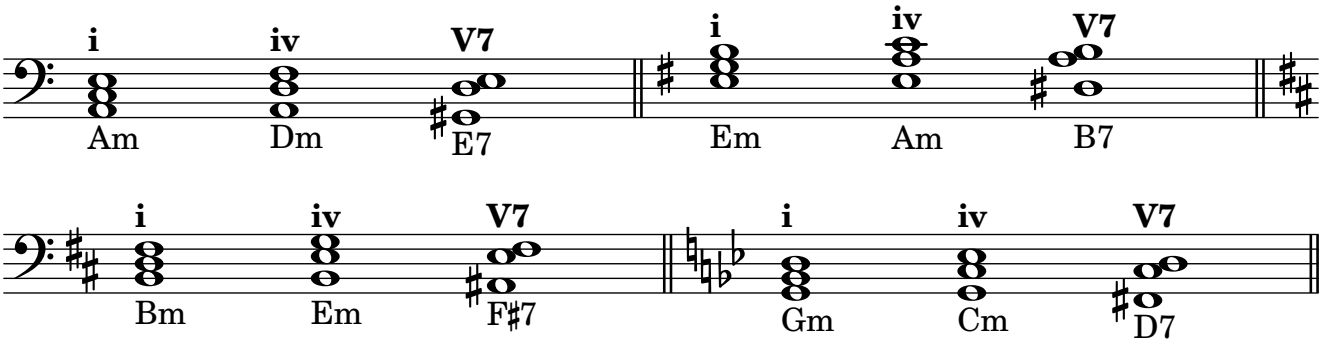
V7 = F♯7

G minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Gm **iv** = Cm **V7** = D7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

How long an accidental lasts

An accidental lasts until the next bar line, for that note only. In the next bar the key signature is back in charge. Here a reminder natural (or sharp) is printed in the next bar to help you.

The raised 7th

A minor: G-sharp. E minor: D-sharp. B minor: A-sharp. G minor: F-sharp. It appears in the V7 chord and, in the right hand, just below the tonic, where the thumb stretches down to it.

Minor chord shapes

i and iv are minor chords (lower-case numbers); V7 is the same shape as in a major key but its bottom note is the raised 7th, so it carries the accidental.

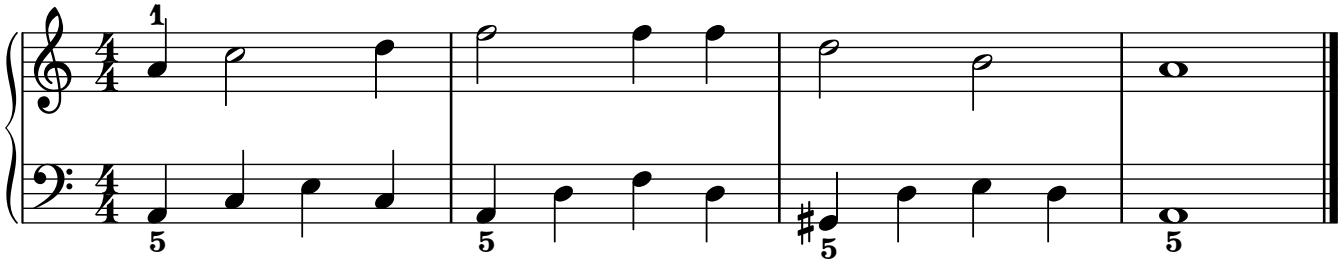
Reading tips

1. In your scan, look for the accidentals: in these keys they come in the V7 bars, usually near the end.
2. When you see the raised 7th, expect the tonic next.
3. After a bar with an accidental, read the next bar carefully: the note goes back to the key signature.

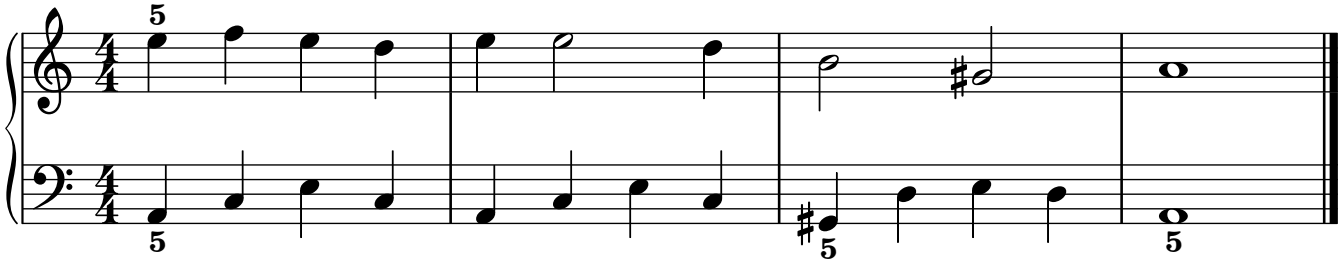
Part A: A minor: G-sharp ♩ = 60

A minor. G-sharp appears in the V7 shape (finger 5) and, in the right hand, under the thumb.

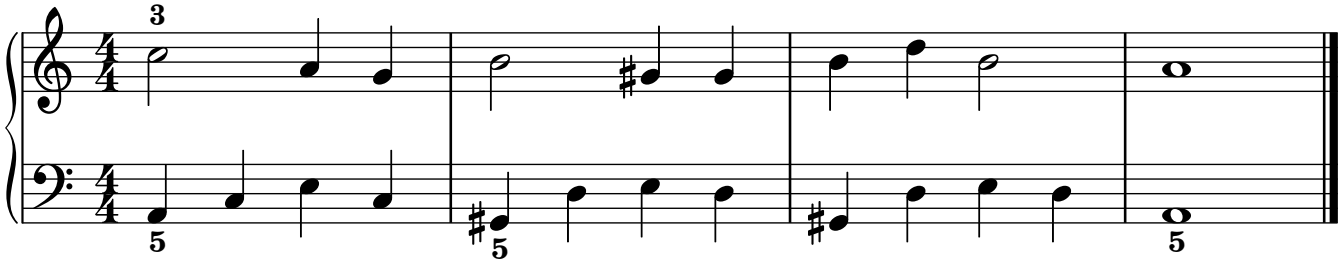
☐ **6.1**



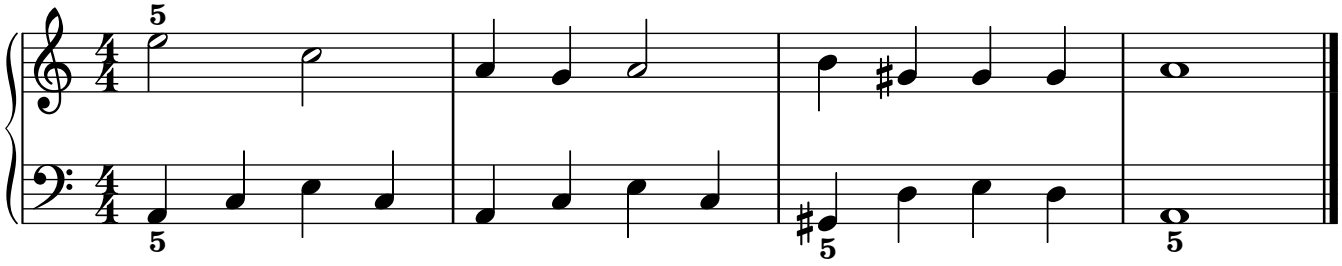
☐ **6.2**



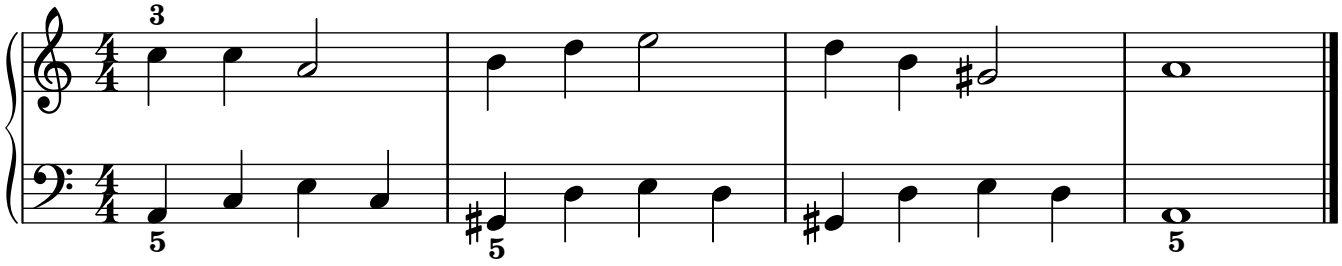
☐ **6.3**



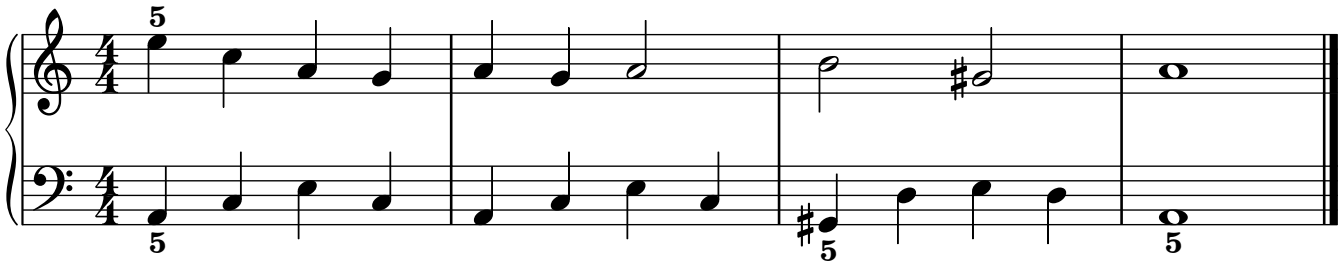
☐ **6.4**



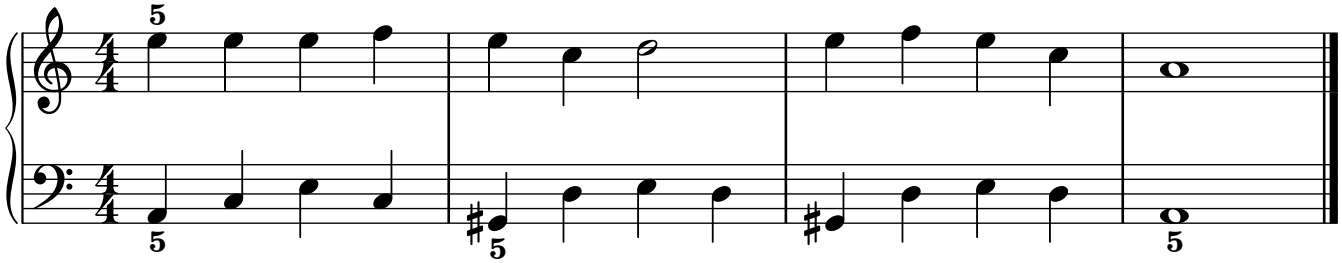
☐ **6.5**



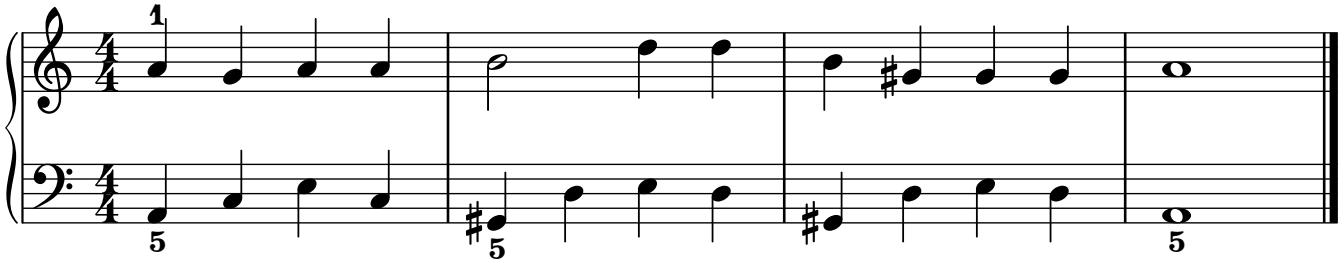
☐ **6.6**



☐ **6.7**



☐ **6.8**



Part B: E minor: D-sharp ♩ = 72

E minor in 3/4. The raised 7th is D-sharp.

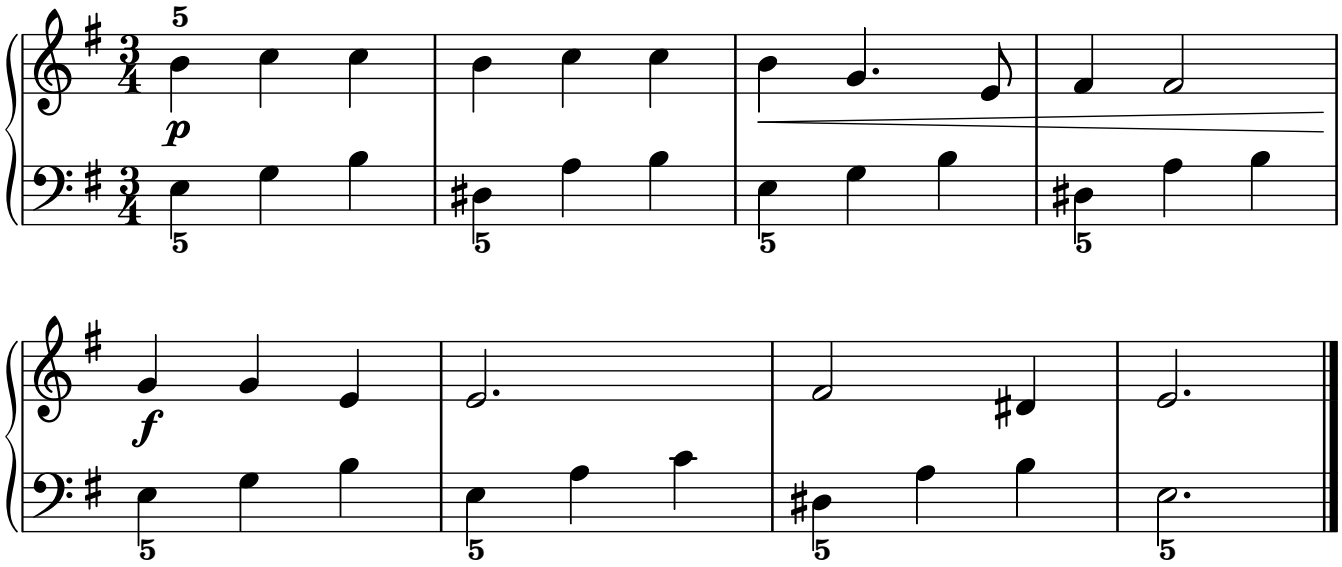
☐ **6.9**



☐ **6.10**



6.11



6.12



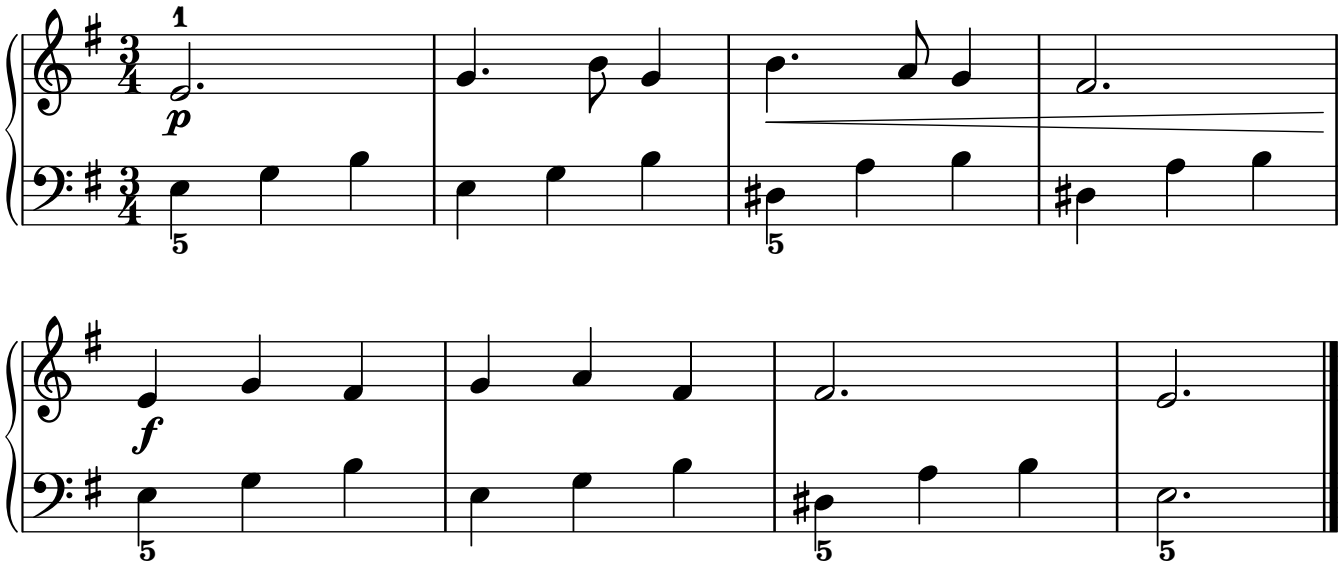
6.13



6.14



6.15



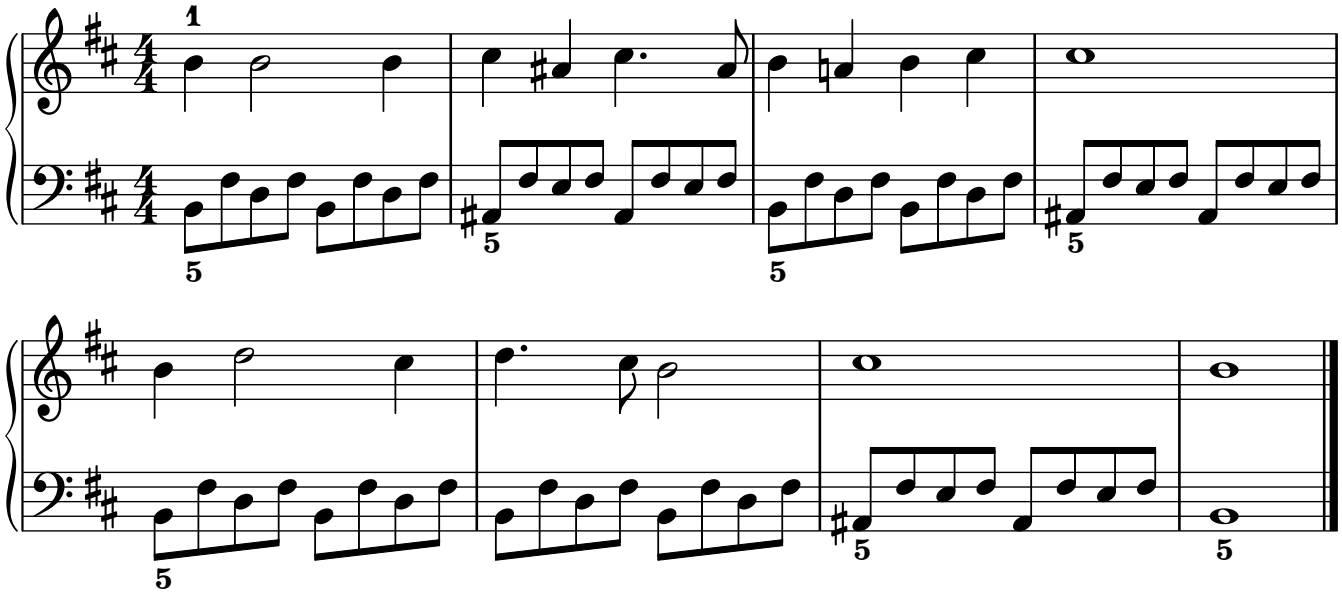
6.16



Part C: B minor: A-sharp ♩ = 60

B minor with an Alberti bass. Two sharps in the key signature, and A-sharp as an accidental.

☐ **6.17**



☐ **6.18**



6.19



6.20



6.21



6.22



6.23



6.24



Part D: G minor: F-sharp ♩. = 50

G minor in 6/8. Two flats in the key signature, and F-sharp as an accidental.

☐ **6.25**



☐ **6.26**



6.27



6.28



6.29



6.30



6.31



6.32



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Greensleeves ♩ = 76

Traditional English tune (16th century) - simplified

The tune uses G and G-sharp: G in bars 4 and 12, G-sharp (with F-sharp) in bars 6, 7 and 14. Each sharp lasts only to the end of its bar. The right hand stays near A position; the thumb moves down for the low E in bar 8 and the F-sharp in bar 14.



Song in G minor ♩ = 72

Original

Two flats in the key signature and an F-sharp in every V7 bar, in both hands. In bar 6 the right hand stretches finger 5 up to E-flat.



Dance in B minor ♩. = 56

Original

A-sharp is the raised 7th of B minor. The right-hand thumb stretches down to it in bars 2 and 7, and it is the bottom note of the left hand's V7 shape.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

- Play five new exercises from Parts B to D at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Every raised 7th is played sharp, and the same note in the next bar goes back to the key signature.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.